Glossary

B

biofuel, n. a combustible (burnable) fuel made from the remains of recently living organisms (48)

C

cost–effective, adj. describing the balance of factors when benefits outweigh costs (33)

E

electricity, n. a form of energy resulting from the flow of charged particles (3)

F

fossil fuel, n. a fuel formed from the fossilized remains of organisms (2)

fuel cell, n. a device in which a chemical reaction takes place to produce electricity, similar to a battery (50)

G

geothermal energy, n. energy produced by heat that is transferred from Earth's interior (43)

greenhouse gas, n. a gas that traps heat in Earth's atmosphere (20)

H

hybrid, n. a combination of two types; a vehicle that uses two different sources of fuel (49)

hydroelectric power, n. electricity generated by the energy in moving water, usually through a dam (31)

N

nonrenewable resource, n. a resource that cannot be restored as quickly as it is used (1)

nuclear energy, n. energy produced by the splitting of atoms, tiny particles of matter (21)

R

renewable resource, n. a resource that can be restored more quickly than it is used up (1)

S

solar cell, n. a device that converts sunlight to electricity (37)

solar power, n. the use of sunlight to meet energy needs (37)

W

wind farm, n. many wind turbines installed together in an area to generate electricity for a community (28)



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